



Pedal power

The tank's commander and driver sat at the front of the tank. The commander used pedals to control the tank's speed, and the driver used levers to turn the tank by stopping one of the two sets of tracks.

The Mark IV's commander was also in charge of the forward weapon, which was either a Lewis or Hotchkiss machine gun.

LITTLE WILLIE



The first working tank model was designed by the British Royal Navy rather than the Army and was originally known as a "Landship" or a "Land Caterpillar." It was built in 1915 and nicknamed "Little Willie." After some design changes, its size and shape changed to that of the Mark IV, so Little Willie is the only example of its kind ever built.



After the debut of the Mark IV at Messines, another 1,200 were built. It saw the most action of any tank in the war.

Stuck in the mud

If a tank got trapped in mud, its crew had to hitch a long, rectangular wooden and metal pole called an unditching beam to the front of its tracks. This made a solid surface that the tank was able to drive over and free itself.

At 26 ft 3 in (8 m), Mark IVs were as long as a bus. They were 13 ft 6 in (4.11 m) wide and 7 ft 11 in (2.43 m) tall.

